Category 2 ambulance response

Forecast for October 2026 · data through September 2026

The latest Category 2 ambulance response result was 31.3 min. For the next release, it is expected to worsen to 33.7 min. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement, partly offset by an improving underlying trend. The current projection is off course for 25 minutes during 2026/27. Across providers, sustained adverse signals outnumber favourable ones (3 to 0).

LATEST · SEPTEMBER 2026	FORECAST · OCTOBER 2026	ACTUAL
31.3 min	**33.7 min**	—
0.4 min above forecast	80% expected range 27.9 min–38.9 min	Not yet released
		Off course · 25 minutes during 2026/27

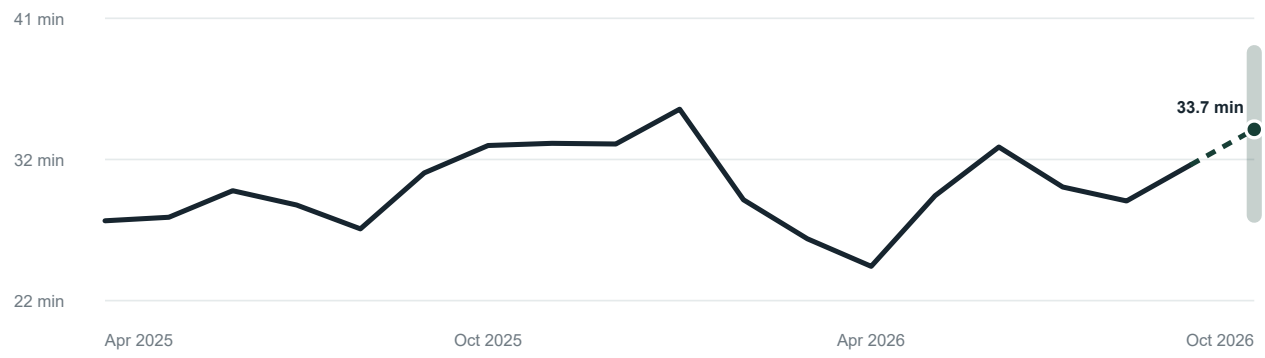
WHAT CHANGED?

Category 2 ambulance response deteriorated in the latest month. The current imported series does not contain a reconciled activity denominator, so this page describes the movement but does not attribute it to demand or throughput.

Monthly	Annual	Volume breakdown
+2.4	+0.5	Not available

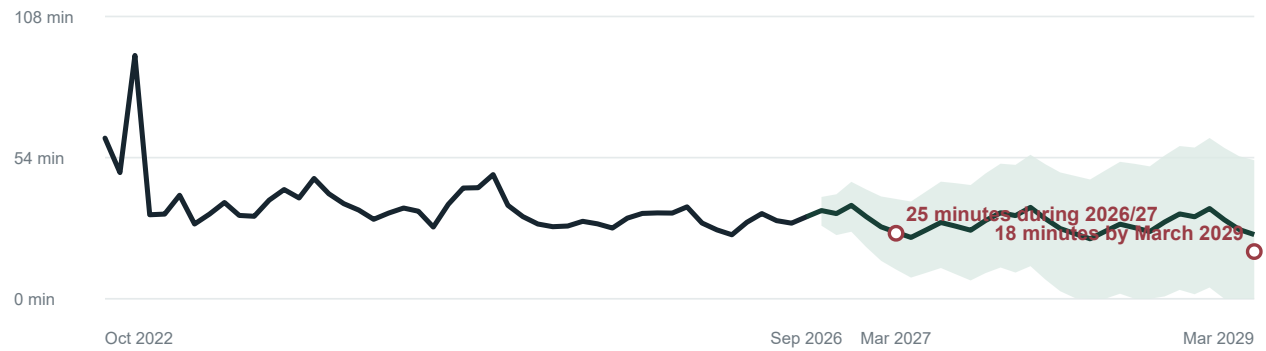
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 18-minute standard. 0.4 min above milestone

Data: NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

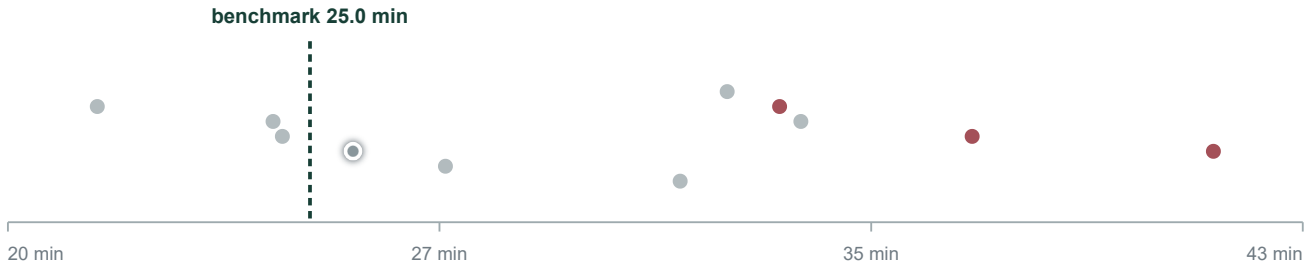
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 110 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

Category 2 ambulance response

Distribution and trajectory watch · September 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

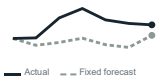
11	0	3	8
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

Largest sustained favourable moves

No qualifying signal.

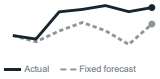
Largest sustained adverse moves

SOUTH WESTERN AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 37.0 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window



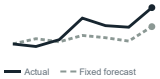
9.9 min
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

LONDON AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST
Latest 33.5 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window



5.0 min
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

EAST OF ENGLAND AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST
Latest 41.4 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window



3.4 min
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.